

9.1. Laptop Security

Laptop theft is one of the most common of hi-tech crimes. Industry statistics estimate that well over 6,00,000 laptops are stolen every year with financial losses running into thousands of crores of rupees. When you lose your laptop, you not only lose the physical machine—you also lose the information stored on it, which in some cases could have irreplaceable commercial value. Take these precautions and protect both your intellectual as well as physical property.

9.1.1. The basics

- When travelling, make sure you keep your belongings in sight at all times.
- The same goes for conferences and meetings. Keep your laptop in view at all times. If you need to go out of the room, take it with you, or ask a colleague to keep an eye on it.
- If you have to go for a meeting without a laptop and want to leave it in a vehicle, keep it covered or in the boot, not in plain sight.
- Do not use flashy cases to carry your laptop—make it as inconspicuous as you possibly can.
- Have an external backup device and ensure that all important data is regularly backed up.
- Use a pen drive to store your sensitive data. Of course, you need to ensure that you also keep the pen drive safe!
- Register the laptop with the manufacturer. This will help in recovery if a stolen laptop is returned for servicing or repair.
- Use tracking software to have the laptop call home. While not so easily available in India, tracking software enable one to track

